



Call for Proposals for Research Funding

Academic Year 2025-26

Overview

Gies College of Business is pleased to announce a fourth round of one-time research funding, with up to \$1 million to be invested in the College faculty's research efforts. As with our three recent prior rounds of funding – which were made possible by remarkably generous gifts from Steven S. Wymer – proposals will fit into one of three buckets in terms of the size of financial support:

- Small – up to \$25,000
- Medium – \$25,001 to \$75,000
- Large – \$75,001 to \$200,000

The primary investigator (PI) on each proposal must be a tenure-track faculty or specialized faculty member with a full-time appointment in Gies College of Business as of August 16, 2026 (i.e., incoming faculty recruits who start on that date are eligible to apply).

We welcome a wide array of proposals, with the following ideas as illustrative examples:

- Acquisition costs of data sets or human-subjects data for archival, experimental, or qualitative research. Fees for acquisition of human participants from the Gies Business Research Lab or from third parties are eligible for consideration.
- Research assistants, whether hourly or stipend based. Research assistants can be graduate or undergraduate students in Gies Business or another unit at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign.
- Postdoctoral positions to support research activities germane to faculty research agendas, College initiatives and centers, and College strategic priorities, such as those related to diversity, equity, and inclusion.
- Expert human capital for improving the College's business data analytics capabilities by building out of infrastructure for better curating, organizing, and accessing structured and unstructured data.
- Software development or purchase, especially software needed to gather or analyze data that presently are not freely accessible through the College or university. As just one example, custom software for laboratory markets is eligible for consideration.
- Educational or pedagogical data acquisition, extraction, and analyses costs.
- Improvements to the capabilities of any current research initiatives or laboratories within the College.

Investigators who have received funding under prior rounds will be asked to provide a progress update. This update will include the amount of prior funding, the amount of that funding already spent toward the project's success, and planned strategy and timeline for successfully seeing those earlier-funded projects through fruition. It also will provide a link or an attachment of the working paper(s) or article(s) resulting from the prior grant.

Submission Process

[Submit your proposal here](#). The proposal must include:

- An abstract of no more than 200 words
- A narrative no longer than 3 double-spaced pages, 12-point font (bibliographies and exhibits do not count toward the narrative's length limit)
- Indication whether it is a small, medium, or large funding request
- Indication of primary methodology used (e.g., archival, experimental, field study, interview, survey, other).
- A detailed budget

All planned spending from the proposed project must occur before the end of AY28-29 and can begin this academic year. Your budget ([suggested template](#)) should lay out the planned timing of the investment. The cost of fringe benefits must be added to any labor in the request for funding (e.g., RAs). However, there is no need to add the internal cost recovery overhead to your funding requests. Last, please include a CV for the PI and any co-investigators (CIs) that is up to date regarding publications, active working papers, and grants.

Submission Deadline

The deadline to ensure full consideration is **March 31, 2026**. The funding decision target date for on-time submissions is **May 5, 2026**. Applications submitted after the deadline might receive consideration subject to remaining funding, but only after consideration of timely applications.

Evaluation Criteria:

- The ultimate criterion is the project's assessed potential to make a significant incremental contribution(s) to scholarly disciplines housed in or associated with Gies College of Business.
- At the margin, scholarly contributions that also advance the College's current strategic priorities will receive additional favorable consideration. The same is true for proposals that have real potential to lead to material (in amount or in prestige) external sources of additional funding.
- Scholarly contributions could accrue to one or more specific investigator's research efforts (e.g., a specific paper or series of papers) or to a larger set of identified or as yet unidentified Gies investigators' research efforts (as in the case for building out or improving our research infrastructure and research lab capabilities).
- Proposals that have high potential to contribute to multiple projects across multiple researchers in the College over time will be accorded additional weight.
- Stronger track records of prior accomplishments will receive favorable weight. One marker of a PI's and co-investigators' track record is prior high-quality publications, such as those in published top scholarly business journals and those that otherwise have attained strong evidence of contributing to the scholarly literature, practitioner literature, or practice. The nature of expected prior accomplishments differs by position (e.g., different expectations exist for clinical, teaching, or research professors than for tenure-stream faculty) as well as by rank

(e.g., expectations for newer assistant professor differ than from a tenured associate professor).

- Projects with a PI who is an untenured tenure-track faculty will receive additional weight, as will project with a PI who is a newly hired tenure-stream faculty member.

Evaluators

Funding decisions ultimately will be made by the dean in consultation with the executive associate dean of faculty and research and input from an anonymous Research Funding Task Force. Task force members will still be eligible for funding but must recuse themselves when their proposals are being considered.

Other Guidelines and Responsibilities:

- Only specialized and tenure-stream faculty having at least a 50% Gies faculty appointment are eligible to apply as PIs. PIs are fully responsible for compliance with all campus policies, as well as any budgetary overages.
- Doctoral students and postdocs with Gies appointments are eligible to submit as co-investigators, but their dissertation or research supervisor must be the PI. In such cases, the supervisory faculty member PI retains responsibility for compliance with all campus policies, as well as any budgetary overages.
- A PI can appear on no more than two additional research funding proposals (i.e., maximum of three).
- For activities involving IRB or other research protocols, the PI is responsible for consulting with the relevant offices and complying with all requirements.
- To the best of the PI's knowledge, all the information provided in the application must be correct.
- Submission implies consent to quote or use the abstract to describe projects selected for funding.
- PIs must provide a complete accounting of how and when they invested the requested funds on an annual basis.
- Researchers who are unaffiliated with Gies or who have an FTE appointment of less than 50% are eligible to be only co-investigator members of research teams.